

Quartermaster's Ledger of Unsettled Wards

Ashen Era — Inventory and Appraisal Leaves

Entry	Subject	Classification	Quartermaster's Record
—	Bryony Nightbrook	Person; minor figure of the Ashen Era	Born in 249 AS . Serves as a Quartermaster . No canonical physical features are established for Bryony Nightbrook; her visual identity is limited to her role as a Quartermaster. Let no clerk draw a face beside her name and call it truth.
—	Bryony Nightbrook	Temperament	No canonical temperament is established for Bryony Nightbrook. Any report naming her kind, cruel, timid, or bold is hearsay unless marked as such. A ledger is not a gossip's cup.
—	The Iron-Ring Cartel	Faction; mercantile league	The Iron-Ring Cartel is a mercantile league running contraband through the ruined trade roads. Its organization is built around commerce conducted across the remnants of the realm's trade routes.
—	The Iron-Ring Cartel	Marks and conduct	Its visual identity is mercantile and hard-edged, reflecting its cartel structure and contraband trade. Its demeanor is calculating, practical, and comfortable operating beyond lawful trade. The Cartel weighs every road, seal, and silence as though each were goods upon a scale.
—	The Thrice-Bound Lantern	Artifact; ward	The Thrice-Bound Lantern is a ward forged in 72 AS . Its threefold binding defines it as a protective object whose strength lies in restraint and containment. No release, sale, transfer, or opening is entered upon this leaf.

—	The Thrice-Bound Lantern	Appearance and observed presence	It is a lantern marked by three visible bindings, with a severe, warding silhouette. It radiates guarded stillness, as though perpetually holding danger at bay. Do not mistake its quiet for emptiness. Quiet is often the last lock remaining.
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Quartermaster’s Marginal Notes

The name **Bryony Nightbrook** is entered here because a Quartermaster must know which distinctions are certain and which are merely repeated until they grow barnacles. Her birth year, **249 AS**, is certain for this record. Her service as a **Quartermaster** is certain. Beyond that, the page keeps its mouth shut.

The name **The Iron-Ring Cartel** is entered with the caution due to all commerce that travels where lawful wagons will not. The ruined trade roads are its working ground, and contraband is its business. I record no claim of loyalty, ownership, or custody between the Cartel, Bryony Nightbrook, and the ward. Such claims would be additions, not accounts.

The **Thrice-Bound Lantern**, forged in **72 AS**, is to be described only by its three visible bindings and its purpose as a protective ward. Its strength lies in restraint and containment. Whether it guards coin, blood, a road, or nothing a sane clerk should name is not established here.

Seal instruction: preserve the entries as written. A forged fact may open a door more readily than a forged key.